

Book
No 7

2022

MULTILEVEL PRACTICE TEST



READING
LISTENING
WRITING
SPEAKING

70 questions

70 questions



WITH AUDIO

BY
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TEST A

LISTENING TEST

Part 1

Questions 1-7 You will hear some sentences. Choose the best reply to each sentence.

- 1 A. When it reaches 25 degrees.
 B. I agree with you.
 C. They'll be on air in about an hour

- A. It was delicious.
- 2 B. Yes, the service is rather slow tonight.
 C. I'll order the tomato pasta.

- A. Hold the line, please.
- 3 B. Some empty boxes.
 C. Try calling back later.

- A. I forgot the singer's name.
- 4 B. Where is the concert?
 C. Yes, he has a wonderful voice.

- A. You need a transit card.
- 5 B. The bus stop is over there.
 C. It is headed downtown.

- A. The window faces toward the street.
- 6 B. Between Williams street and Keller Avenue.
 C. It was very informative.

- A. Actually, I prefer working alone.
- 7 B. Let's gather the company's data.
 C. Before next Friday

Part 2

Questions 8-12 Complete the sentences. For each question, write the correct answer in the gap. Write NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS for each answer.

Peter consumes far too much *soft drink*

Peter and Mary's diet will be both sensible and 8 _____

Every two months, they can eat 9 _____

On Saturdays, they will go 10 _____

This coming Saturday, they will go to 11 _____

In every meal, there will be 12 _____

Part 3

You will hear five short extracts in which people are talking about listening to music. For questions 13-17, choose from the list A-H what each speaker says about listening to music. Use the letters only once. There are three extra letters which you do not need to use.

13.Speaker 1 _____

14.Speaker 2 _____

15.Speaker 3 _____

16.Speaker 4 _____

17.Speaker 5 _____

A. It helps me to focus at work.

B. It brings back memories.

C. It is a good way to relax.

D. It provides me with inspiration.

E. It is a requirement of my job.

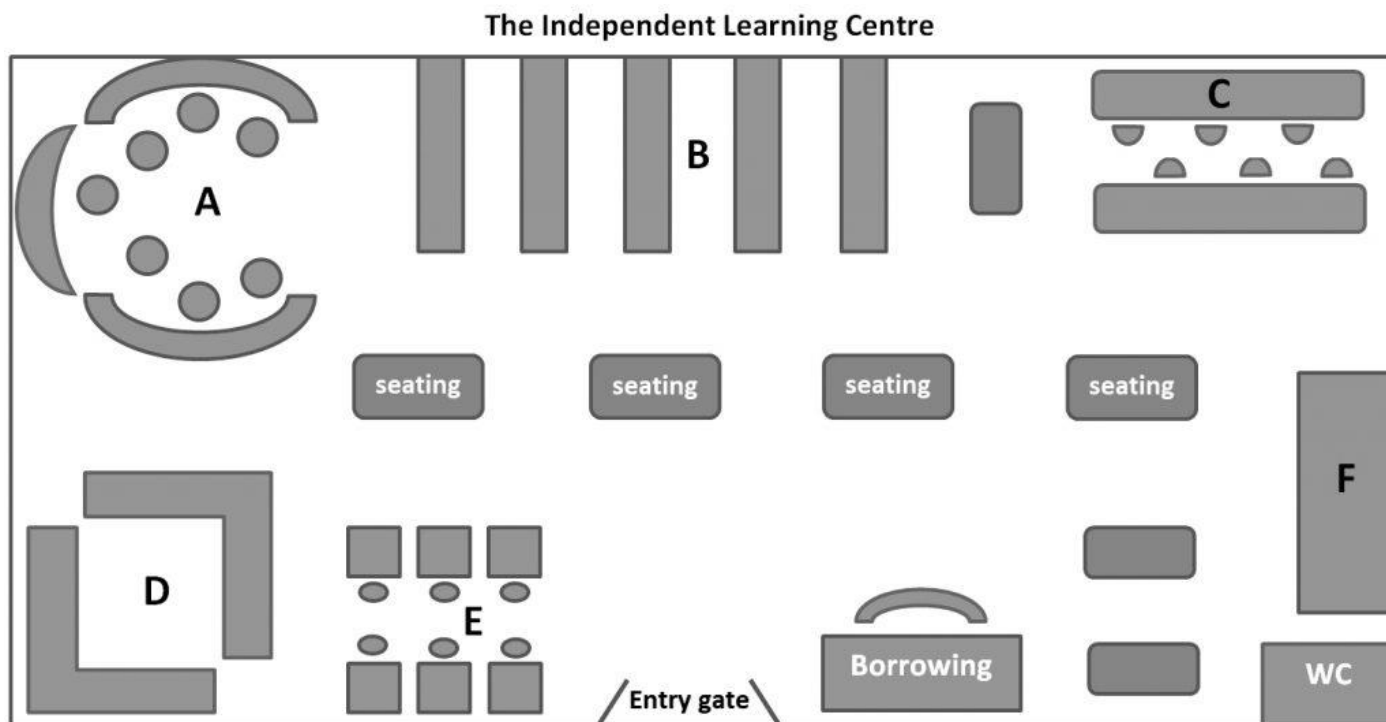
F. It makes me feel more energetic.

G. It makes time seem to pass more quickly.

H. It is something I can sit and enjoy with other people.

Part 4

Label the map below. Write the correct letter, A-F, next to Questions 18-23



- 18. Quiet reading____
- 19. Computers____
- 20. Newspapers & magazines____
- 21. Reference books____
- 22. Audio section____
- 23. Main library____

Part 5

You will hear three different extracts. For questions 24-29, choose the answer (A, B or C) which fits best according to what you hear. There are two questions for each extract.

Extract One

You hear two people discussing a radio programme.

24. What do the people have different opinions about?

- A. how interesting the programme is
- B. the website design
- C. the choice of the objects in the collection

25. What does the woman like about the programme?

- A. the consistency of quality in the interviews
- B. the fact that it is educational
- C. the way they talk about history

Extract Two

You hear two teachers discussion student selection procedure.

26. What does the woman say about the procedure in her department?

- A. it could have been more efficient.
- B. it does not necessarily help admit the best students.
- C. going through the application forms is very tedious.

27. What part of the man's suggestion worries the woman?

- A. if it would be any better than the current approach
- B. if her colleagues would like it
- C. if the procedure would be secure

Extract Three

You hear two people discussing a project they are working on.

28. What is the project?

- A. putting up decorations in a room
- B. building an extension to a house
- C. renovating a room

29. Both speakers agree that

- A. they could learn something from this work.
- B. it is a relief that the work will start soon.
- C. the process will cause certain discomfort.

Part 6

Questions 30-35. Complete the notes.

Write ONE WORD OR A NUMBER for each answer.

Nicolaus Copernicus	started the Copernican 30 _____ his book published the year he was 31 _____ and then passed away This book generated little 32 _____
Other scientists	Galileo was persecuted. 33 _____ was killed. even the sun believed to be in 34 _____
Modern geocentrism	based on the 35 _____ Believers also support creationism.

READING TEST

Part 1

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

The Joy of Reading

Have you ever wondered why people read? Why reading is one of the few things that has consistently remained part of society for thousands of years? Even before **1**_____ became available to the general public, stories were told around campfires, passed down from generation to generation.

First of all, **2**_____ are a good way to escape from your ordinary life, to get immersed in another world, if only for a little time. While reading, you can imagine yourself in different situations that range from unlikely to impossible, but in the moment that doesn't matter. Whether you're suffering from depression or are just bored, reading is a great distraction.

Similarly, another reason **3**_____ are attracted to stories, is because they are lonely, very often they feel as if they are the only ones in the world going through something difficult. Identifying with a fictional character can make a big difference in helping people understand that they are not alone.

Other people read because it can be a good way to relax. It can be very nice to sit down and enjoy a good plot unfold, to watch the actions of fictional characters from the side, and to see the consequences of these **4**_____, without having to bear any responsibility.

Lastly, people read because it is the easiest **5**_____ to gain knowledge in a certain area. Instead of finding a teacher, you can just find a **6**_____, sit down, and spend a few hours reading. This way you can study wherever you want, whenever you want at your own pace.

There are countless books in the world, and whoever you are, whatever you're feeling, there is definitely a book out there, just waiting for you to discover it.

Part 2

Read the statements 1-8 and the texts A-P. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used ONCE only.

7

**NO BICYCLES
AGAINST GLASS
PLEASE**

11

BE PREPARED
SCHOOL ENTRANCE
AHEAD
DEAD SLOW

8

MESSAGE
*Harry,
Ron says he missed the bus. He'll
have to wait an hour for the next
one. Can you tell Sue he's sorry.*

12

**FRESHLY PAINTED
DO NOT TOUCH**

9

NO FRESH FISH TODAY
WE REGRET THAT DUE TO RECENT
BAD WEATHER NO FRESH FISH HAS
BEEN DELIVERED

13

SECURITY
PLEASE DON'T LEAVE LUGGAGE
UNATTENDED. ANY UNATTENDED
LUGGAGE WILL BE REMOVED AND
MAY BE DESTROYED.

10

IT IS FORBIDDEN TO CHEW GUM
ON THE SCHOOL PREMISES.
ANYONE CAUGHT CHEWING
GUM WILL BE REPORTED TO THE
PRINCIPAL

14

BOOKS IN THE CAFE
PLEASE REMEMBER THAT ONLY BOOKS
THAT HAVE BEEN PAID FOR MAY BE
TAKEN INTO THE BOOK SHOP CAFE

- A. The weather is responsible for the problem.
- B. The fish shop is responsible for the problem
- C. You must not take any unpaid for books to the cafe.
- D. You should pay for your books in the cafe.
- E. Do not leave your bicycle touching the window.
- F. You must always be with your luggage.
- G. Harry is apologising.
- H. You must not eat chewing gum in school.
- I. Chewing gum is bad for you.
- J. You have to paint something.
- K. Ron is apologising.
- L. They will destroy unattended luggage.
- M. Somebody needs to enter the school.
- N. Broken glass may damage your bicycle tyres.
- O. Somebody needs to change speed.
- P. You must not touch something

Part 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of headings

- I. Reasons for immigration.
- II. European immigrants.
- III. American immigration in the 60s.
- IV. Prohibition of slavery in 19thC,
- V. Measures to reduce immigration.
- VI. Looking for a new opportunity.
- VII. Survival of immigration despite economic problems.
- VIII. Religious discrimination

- 15.Paragraph A____
- 16.Paragraph B____
- 17.Paragraph C____
- 18.Paragraph D____
- 19.Paragraph E____
- 20.Paragraph F____

Immigrations to the United States

- A.** The United States of America has long been the world's chief receiving nation for immigrants. An immigrant is a person who leaves his or her country to settle and live in another country. Over the years, many millions of people have uprooted and left family and friends to move to America. Some felt forced to leave because they feared for their lives due to dangers present in their home countries. For example, many immigrants left countries that were at war or that didn't give them the freedom to practice their faith. Immigrants also left their native lands if they couldn't find work or enough food to live. Whatever the reason, immigrants usually have had to sacrifice a life that is familiar for one that is unknown.
- B.** The United States was founded by immigrants. From the 1600s through 1775, European colonists settled in the land that is now the United States. Most of these immigrants were from England. Others arrived from France, Germany, Ireland, Scotland, and Spain. Many of these colonists came here looking for economic opportunity. They wanted better land to farm or better work. Others came to escape religious persecution. Some were even convicts brought over from English jails. West Africans also immigrated to the American colonies, but they came against their will. They were captured, sold into slavery, and shipped to the colonies.
- C.** Since the United States was established in the late 1700s, it has seen three waves of immigration. The first wave of American immigration took place from 1820 to 1870. Over seven million people made the voyage to America, mostly from northern and western Europe. About a third of these immigrants were Irish people trying to escape a famine that plagued Ireland in the mid-1840s. Another third of the immigrants from this wave were German. The Chinese also began to immigrate to America during this time. They got word of the Gold Rush in California. They came to work in the mines and get rich.
- D.** This flood of immigrants wasn't always welcome by those already in America. Some feared these newcomers would take away their jobs. Others didn't like the politics,

customs, and/or religions the new immigrants brought with them. For example, many Irish people were discriminated against for being Roman Catholic. The Chinese also suffered greatly from discrimination.

- E. The third wave of immigration began in 1965 and continues today. Most immigrants in this wave have come from Asian countries as well as South American countries, Caribbean countries, and Mexico. A large number of these immigrants have settled in the East and Midwest. However, many others have moved to California.
- F. Most immigrants have come to America with the hope of building a better life. However, they were sometimes met with hatred by the people already living in the country who feared the economic and cultural impacts of these newcomers. While this discrimination and the economic downfall of the Great Depression had a negative effect on immigration, American immigration has managed to survive.

Part 4

Read the following text for questions 21-29

Coal is expected to continue to account for almost 27 per cent of the world's energy needs. However, with growing international awareness of pressures on the environment and the need to achieve sustainable development of energy resources, the way in which the resource is extracted, transported and used is critical. A wide range of pollution control devices and practices is in place at most modern mines and significant resources are spent on rehabilitating mined land. In addition, major research and development programmes are being devoted to lifting efficiencies and reducing emissions of greenhouse gases during coal consumption. Such measures are helping coal to maintain its status as a major supplier of the world's energy needs.

The coal industry has been targeted by its critics as a significant contributor to the greenhouse effect. However, the greenhouse effect is a natural phenomenon involving the increase in global surface temperature due to the presence of greenhouse gases – water vapour, carbon dioxide, tropospheric ozone, methane and nitrous oxide – in the atmosphere. Without the greenhouse effect, the earth's average surface temperature would be 33-35 degrees C lower, or -15 degrees

Life on earth, as we know it today, would not be possible. There is concern that this natural phenomenon is being altered by a greater build-up of gases from human activity, perhaps giving rise to additional warming and changes in the earth's climate. This additional build-up and its forecast outcome has been called the enhanced greenhouse effect. Considerable uncertainty exists, however, about the enhanced greenhouse effect, particularly in relation

to the extent and timing of any future increases in global temperature. Greenhouse gases arise from a wide range of sources and their increasing concentration is largely related to the compound effects of increased population, improved living standards and changes in lifestyle. From a current base of 5 billion, the United Nations predicts that the global population may stabilise in the twenty-first century between 8 and 14 billion, with more than 90 per cent of the projected increase taking place in the world's developing nations. The associated activities to support that growth, particularly to produce the required energy and food, will cause further increases in greenhouse gas emissions. The challenge, therefore, is to attain a sustainable balance between population, economic growth and the environment.

The major greenhouse gas emissions from human activities are carbon dioxide (CO₂), methane and nitrous oxide. Chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs) are the only major contributor to the greenhouse effect that does not occur naturally, coming from such sources as refrigeration, plastics and manufacture. Coal's total contribution to greenhouse gas emissions is thought to be about 18 per cent, with about half of this coming from electricity generation.

The world-wide coal industry allocates extensive resources to researching and developing new technologies and ways of capturing greenhouse gases. Efficiencies are likely to be improved dramatically, and hence CO₂ emissions reduced, through combustion and gasification techniques which are now at pilot and demonstration stages. Clean coal is another avenue for improving fuel conversion efficiency. Investigations are under way into superclean coal (3-5 per cent ash) and ultraclean coal (less than 1 per cent ash). Superclean coal has the potential to enhance the combustion efficiency of conventional pulverised fuel power plants. Ultraclean coal will enable coal to be used in advanced power systems such as coal-fired gas turbines which, when operated in combined cycle, have the potential to achieve much greater efficiencies.

Defendants of mining point out that, environmentally, coal mining has two important factors in its favour. It makes only temporary use of the land and produces no toxic chemical wastes. By carefully pre-planning projects, implementing pollution control measures, monitoring the effects of mining and rehabilitating mined areas, the coal industry minimises the impact on the neighbouring community, the immediate environment and long-term land capability. Dust levels are controlled by spraying roads and stockpiles, and water pollution is controlled by carefully separating clean water runoff from runoff which contains sediments or salt from mine workings. The latter is treated and re-used for dust suppression. Noise is controlled by modifying equipment and by using insulation and sound enclosures around machinery. Since mining activities represent only a

temporary use of the land, extensive rehabilitation measures are adopted to ensure that land capability after mining meets agreed and appropriate standards which, in some cases, are superior to the land's pre-mining condition. Where the mining is underground, the surface area can be simultaneously used for forests, cattle grazing and crop raising, or even reservoirs and urban development, with little or no disruption to the existing land use. In all cases, mining is subject to stringent controls and approvals processes.

In open-cut operations, however, the land is used exclusively for mining but land rehabilitation measures generally progress with the mine's development. As core samples are extracted to assess the quality and quantity of coal at a site, they are also analysed to assess the ability of the soil or subsoil material to support vegetation. Topsoils are stripped and stockpiled prior to mining for subsequent dispersal over rehabilitated areas. As mining ceases in one section of the open-cut, the disturbed area is reshaped. Drainage within and off the site is carefully designed to make the new land surface as stable as the local environment allows: often dams are built to protect the area from soil erosion and to serve as permanent sources of water. Based on the soil requirements, the land is suitably fertilised and revegetated.

Questions 21-25

Choose the appropriate letters A-D and write them in boxes 21-25 on your answer sheet.

- 21.** The global increase in greenhouse gases has been attributed to
- A.** industrial pollution in developing countries.
 - B.** coal mining and electricity generation.
 - C.** reduced rainfall in many parts of the world.
 - D.** trends in population and lifestyle.
- 22.** The proportion of all greenhouse gases created by coal is approximately
- A.** 14 per cent.
 - B.** 18 per cent.
 - C.** 27 per cent.
 - D.** 90 per cent.
- 23.** Current research aims to increase the energy-producing efficiency of coal by
- A.** burning it at a lower temperature.
 - B.** developing new gasification techniques.
 - C.** extracting CO₂ from it.
 - D.** recycling greenhouse gases.
- 24.** Compared with ordinary coal, new, 'clean' coals may generate power
- A.** more cleanly and more efficiently.
 - B.** more cleanly but less efficiently.

- C. more cleanly but at higher cost.
- D. more cleanly but much more slowly.

25. To control dust at mine sites, mining companies often use

- A. chemicals which may be toxic.
- B. topsoil taken from the site before mining.
- C. fresh water from nearby dams.
- D. runoff water containing sediments.

Questions 26-29

Do the following statements reflect the opinions of the writer in the Reading Passage?

26. The coal industry should be abandoned in favour of alternative energy sources because of the environmental damage it causes.

- A) True B) False C) Not Given

27. The greatest threats to the environment are the gases produced by industries which support the high standard of living of a growing world population.

- A) True B) False C) Not Given

28. World population in the twenty-first century will probably exceed 8 billion.

- A) True B) False C) Not Given

29. CFC emissions have been substantially reduced in recent years.

- A) True B) False C) Not Given

Part 5

Talc Powder

Agriculture and Food, in Europe, explains that chewing gums has four main components. "The most important of them is the gum base," he says. "It's the gum base that puts the chew into chewing gum. It binds all the ingredients together, creating a soft, smooth texture. To this the manufacturer adds sweeteners, softeners and flavourings. Our talc is used as a filler in the gum base. The amount varies between, say, ten and 35 per cent, depending on the type of gum. Fruit flavoured chewing gum, for example, is slightly acidic and would react with the calcium carbonate that the manufacturer might otherwise use as a filler. Talc, on the other hand, makes an ideal filler because it's non-reactive chemically. In the factory, talc is also used to dust the gum base pellets and to stop the chewing gum sticking during the lamination and packing process," Delord adds.

The chewing gum business is, however, just one example of talc's use in the food sector. For the past 20 years or so, olive oil processors in Spain have been taking advantage of talc's unique characteristics to help them boost the amount of oil they extract from crushed olives. According to Patrick Delord, talc is especially useful for treating what he calls "difficult" olives. After the olives are harvested – preferably early in the morning because their taste is better if they are gathered in the cool of the day – they are taken to the processing plant. There they are crushed and then stirred for 30-45 minutes. In the old days, the resulting paste was passed through an olive press but nowadays it's more common to add water and centrifuge the mixture to separate the water and oil from the solid matter. The oil and water are then allowed to settle so that the olive oil layer can be decanted off and bottle. "Difficult" olives are those that are more reluctant than the norm to yield up their full oil content. This may be attributable to the particular species of olive, or to its water content and the time of year the olives are collected – at the beginning and the end of the season their water content is often either too high or too low. These olives are easy to recognize because they produce a lot of extra foam during the stirring process, a consequence of an excess of a fine solid that acts as a natural emulsifier. The oil in this emulsion is lost when the water is disposed of. Not only that, if the wastewater is disposed of directly into local fields – often the case in many smaller processing operations – the emulsified oil may take some time to biodegrade and so be harmful to the environment.

"If you add between a half and two per cent of talc by weight during the stirring process, it absorbs the natural emulsifier in the olives and so boosts the amount of oil you can extract," says Delord. "In addition, talc's flat, 'platey' structure helps increase the size of the oil droplets liberated during stirring, which again improves the yield. However, because talc is chemically inert, it doesn't affect the colour, taste, appearance or composition of the resulting olive oil."

If the use of talc in olive oil processing and in chewing gum is long-established, new applications in the food and agriculture industries are also constantly being sought by Luzenac. One such promising new market is fruit crop protection, being pioneered in the US. Just like people, fruit can get sunburned. In fact, in very sunny regions up to 45 per cent of a typical crop can be affected by heat stress and sunburn. However, in the case of fruit, it's not so much the ultraviolet rays which harm the crop as the high surface temperature that the sun's rays create.

To combat this, farmers normally use either chemicals or spray a continuous fine canopy of mist above the fruit trees or bushes. The trouble is, this uses a lot of water – normally a precious commodity in hot, sunny areas – and it is therefore expensive. What's more, the ground can quickly become waterlogged. "So our idea was to coat the fruit with talc to

protect it from the sun,” says Greg Hunter, a marketing specialist who has been with Luzenac for ten years. “But to do this, several technical challenges had first to be overcome. Talc is very hydrophobic: it doesn’t like water. So in order to have a viable product we needed a wettable powder – something that would go readily into suspension so that it could be sprayed onto the fruit. It also had to break the surface tension of the cutin (the natural waxy, waterproof layer on the fruit) and of course, it had to wash off easily when the fruit was harvested. No-one’s going to want an apple that’s covered in talc.”

Questions 30-35

Complete the following summary of the paragraphs of Reading Passage, using NO MORE THAN TWO WORDS from the Reading Passage for each answer.

Spanish olive oil industry has been using talc in the oil extraction process for about **30**_____ years. It is useful in dealing with difficult olives which often produce a high amount of **31**_____ because of the high content of solid materials. When smaller factories release **32**_____, it could be **33**_____ to the environment because it is hard to **34**_____ and usually takes time as it contains emulsified. However, talc powder added in the process is able to absorb the emulsified oil. It improves the oil extraction production because with the aid of talc powder, size of oil **35**_____ increased.

TEST B

LISTENING TEST

Part 1

You will hear some sentences. Choose the best reply to each sentence.

- 1 A. The stapler is red.
 B. You left it next to the printer.
 C. We're only allowed one per year

- 2 A. No, thanks. I'm watching my weight.
 B. Yuck! Why would I want my burger fried?
 C. Yeah. I did remember to shake before opening.

- 3 A. It'll be done in five minutes.
 B. It is actually of medium length.
 C. That's not exactly the point I'm making.

- 4 A. No, I don't get it.
 B. Just the check, please.
 C. I didn't say a word to him.

- 5 A. At about 3 p.m.
 B. Yes, around five dollars.
 C. Actually, I like my hair just the way it is.

Part 2

For each question, write the correct answer in the gap. Write one or two words or a number or a date or a time. You will hear a woman talking about a conference.

Seminar on the Toy Industry	
9.30 – 10.00	6 _____ to the seminar by Sally Connor
10.00 - 11.00	<i>Our Company in Tokyo</i> – a talk by Kenji Nakamura followed by a short film
11.00 – 11.30	Half an hour for 7 _____ Buffet lunch in Victoria Hall – 8 _____ the library
2.00 – 3.30	<i>Toys in Britain: Success and Failure</i> – a talk by Robert Price (owner of over 9 _____ toy shops)
3.30 – 5.00	<i>What's Next for Toys?</i> – a talk by Sarah Smith, Sales 10 _____ 11 _____ in the Green Room (1st floor)

Part 3

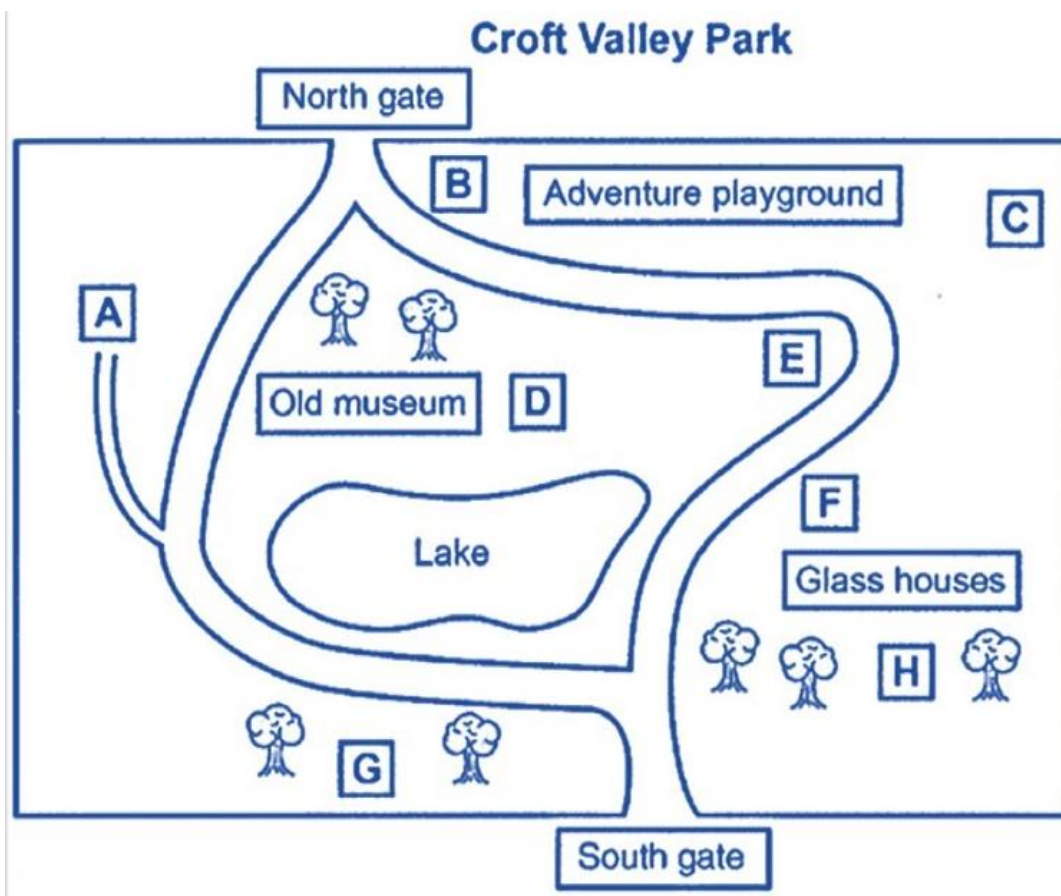
You are going to hear five extracts in which people talk about their reasons for doing voluntary work. For questions 12-16, choose from the list A-H the reason each speaker gives. Use the letters only once. There is one extra letter which you do not need to use.

18. Speaker 1 _____
19. Speaker 2 _____
20. Speaker 3 _____
21. Speaker 4 _____
22. Speaker 5 _____

- A. to practise a hobby
B. to increase self-confidence
C. to deal with a local problem
D. to help someone they know
E. to act as a positive role model
F. to learn practical skills
G. to give something back
H. to make friends and feel they belong

Part 4

Label the map below. Write the correct letter, A-H, next to Questions 17-22



- 17. café___
- 18. toilets___
- 19. formal gardens___
- 20. outdoor gym___
- 21. skateboard ramp___
- 22. wild flowers___

Part 5

You will hear three different extracts. For questions 23-28, choose the answer (A, B or C) which fits best according to what you hear. There are two questions for each extract.

Extract One

You hear two friends, Jeanette and David, talking about playing the guitar.

23 What does Jeanette say about being motivated to practise playing the guitar?

- A. Not wanting to practise sometimes is normal.
- B. Studying how to increase motivation is a waste of time.
- C. There is no link between feeling motivated and musical ability.

24 Why did David take up playing the guitar as a hobby?

- A. to improve his maths skills
- B. to feel less stressed about his college course
- C. to be able to concentrate for longer

Extract Two

You hear two engineers who work in the same company talking on the radio about new technology and roads.

25 At the moment, the man is working on new technology for

- A. road markings.
- B. electric lights on roads.
- C. a special type of road surface.

26 What is the woman doing when she talks about roads made of glass?

- A. reassuring listeners that these roads are safe
- B. clarifying what the man said about these roads
- C. outlining a potential problem with these roads

Extract Three

You hear two sociologists talking about disagreeing.

27 Why does the woman think disagreeing is a complex topic?

- A. People can feel a range of emotions when others disagree with them.
- B. People express disagreement differently depending on their age.
- C. People's reactions to disagreeing depend on their culture.

28 What did the man do when a colleague disagreed with him?

- A. asked questions to try to understand the reasons
- B. repeated his opinion politely
- C. attempted to change the subject

Part 6

You will hear a fabric designer, called Pedro Carwin, talking about sources of inspiration for the design of fabrics used in fashion. For questions 29-35, complete the sentences with a word or short phrase.

INSPIRATION FOR FABRIC DESIGN

Pedro believes that some types of film are better sources of inspiration than others, especially **29**_____ films.

Pedro recommends that designers should look carefully at the **30**_____ of the food when they eat out.

Pedro gets ideas by listening to music and visualising what he calls a **31**_____ of the music.

Pedro is often stimulated by the different **32**_____ of objects in the natural world.

What surprised Pedro most was when a colleague used a **33**_____ for inspiration.

Pedro says that studying the **34**_____ of colours in photos can be helpful.

Pedro uses the word **35**_____ to describe the Art Deco style of architecture, which he particularly appreciates.

READING TEST

Part 1

Read the text. Fill in each gap with ONE word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text.

Friendship and Love

A strong friendship takes a significant amount of time to develop. It will not just magically mature overnight. A **1**_____ involves committing oneself to help another person whenever a need arises. I believe that, nothing can replace a true friend, not material objects, or money, and definitely not a boy.

I met this guy a couple summers ago who **2**_____ ended up spending almost all of my free time with. His parents did not approve of our dating because of our age difference, but we did anyway. He had told me the day we met that he had joined the air force and would leave for overseas that coming October. After three months had past, the time came when he had to **3**_____. This left me feeling completely alone.

I turned to my friends for support, but to my surprise, they did not really care. I had spent so much time with this **4**_____ and so little time with them, that they did not feel sorry for me when he left. For so long **5**_____ had become the only constant in my life, and I had taken them for granted over something could not guarantee would even last.

When my boyfriend came back, our relationship changed. I tried to fix all the aspects in my life that had gone so wrong in the previous six months.

This experience taught me that true friendships will only survive if one puts forth effort to make them last. Keeping friends close will guarantee that someone will always have a shoulder to cry on. When a **6**_____ falls apart, a friend will always do everything in their power to make everything less painful. As for me, I try to keep my **7**_____ as close as I can. I know they will always support me in whatever I do, and to them, I am eternally grateful for a second chance.

Part 2

The people all want to read a book. Read the descriptions of eight books. Decide which book would be most suitable for each person. For Questions 8-12, select the best book.

A. Henry Jowett 'The Portrait of a Woman'

The charming Evelyn Blanchet was a French woman who came to England in the eighteenth century and won the hearts of young men wherever she appeared. This enjoyable romance shows us the elegant evening dresses, the beautiful rooms, and Evelyn's gleaming eyes in an imaginary world full of gardens and palaces.

B. Patience Jones 'The English Corner'

In a quiet English village by the sea, a young French widow gets a second chance at love. Annabel Ginger hasn't been back to the Village of Abberton since she buried her husband two years ago. Now she's returning with her 4-year-old daughter, Alice.

C. Robin Greene 'Migration'

In the dark future of Jupiter XI, more than 90 percent of the world's population died. Most people killed themselves or were killed by others who were listening to voices steering their dreadful actions. Those who survived live in a very hostile environment. There are so many different twists or unexpected turns.

D. Ann Kaufman 'Baby Dance'

This fabulous board book follows five American puppies (including a rather cheeky Yorkie) as they play and dance the day away. Using delightful rhyme and simple language, an American author Ann Kaufman has created a fun, rhythmical story that is a joy to read and alluring to little ears.

E. Bruce Nolan 'Landia'

Landia is a medieval world filled with pirates and warriors, adventures and battles, and a group of boys trying to find their place in the world. The story focuses on a bunch of naughty boys who, as part of their coming of age, must go through six months of tough, physical training on land and sea to become warriors.

F. Automobile Association 'Walks and Tours in England'

A free guide (French edition) with practical tips and advice to help you get the most out of your trip to the United Kingdom. The guide includes detailed information on history, museums, galleries, churches as well as some useful information about

accommodation. There are suggested tour routes, maps and directions.

G. Izaak Watson 'The Perfect Storm'

The "Silver Guide" series from St. George's Press has been around since the late '60s and is known for its comprehensive coverage of a wide range of topics related to nature. "The Perfect Storm" is no exception. The book is widely considered to be one of the leading guidebooks for novice and experienced anglers.

H. Doris McCartney 'The Princess'

Open the book, and you won't be disappointed, for what follows is a fascinating adventure with fantastic places and amazing creatures, all to be found just on the verge of reality, if only you could squeeze through the lavender hedge at the bottom of the garden to find it.

8. James is looking for a book for his granddaughter's fourth birthday present. Ideally, it should be about animals or elves and be a story he can read to her many times.

9. Susan is twenty-one and works for a multinational company. She likes romance novels very much, especially if they contain descriptions of fashionable clothes, magnificent houses, and parties.

10. Andre is from Paris and travels across England on business very often. He would like a book that offers accurate information as he sometimes has time for sightseeing between business meetings.

11. Tia is a chemistry student, but she would like to read science fiction in her free time. She wants to buy a well-written book with a surprise at the end.

12. Peter wants to buy a book as a present for his friend Robin. Robin is keen on fishing and likes spending time in nature.

Part 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below.

There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once.

List of headings

- I. Examples of customization
- II. Unusual keepsakes
- III. A new approach
- IV. A simple cell phone
- V. Unbelievable material
- VI. A strange TV
- VII. Number of products shown on the festival

13.Paragraph A___

14.Paragraph B___

15.Paragraph C___

16.Paragraph D___

17.Paragraph E___

Simplicity reigns at London's biggest design festival.

- A.** One was the launch of two consumer electronics products designed to simplify and beautify our technology-addled lives. Both chose the new London Design Festival venue of Somerset House to show their wares. The first was a mobile phone launched by Swiss company Punkt and designed by Jasper Morrison that allows users to make calls and texts only (well, it has an alarm clock and an address book too). Punkt founder Petter Neby doesn't believe it will replace your smart phone but suggests users fit it with the same SIM card as your main phone and use it in the evenings, weekends and on holiday.
- B.** Customizable online furniture was also very much in vogue at this year's festival. But rest assured, weird and unreliable software or off-the-wall designs sent to a 3D printer somewhere and arriving months later, seem to be a thing of the past. Customization may finally have come of age. Two examples were Scandi-brand Hem that combined good design by the likes of Luca Nichetto, Form Us With Love and Sylvain Willenz with affordable price points. The fact that the brand opened a pop-up

store in Covent Garden during the festival is a recognition of the importance of both physical and online spaces that work seamlessly together.

- C. A definite highlight was the massive space taken over by the Design & Crafts Council of Ireland and filled with weavers and potters doing their thing and showing their wares. Irish Design had another delectable stand over at the Rochelle School in East London too. The Souvenir Project was a series of nine non-cliché 'souvenirs' made in Ireland and included a rainbow plate by Nicholas Mosse Pottery that featured rows of animals, flowers and watering cans and commemorated the legalization of same-sex marriage in Ireland in May 2015.
- D. If there was one material that could be said to define the festival it might just be Jesmonite, the wonder man-made building composite. Lighter and more sustainable than concrete, its dramatic capabilities were brought to life by London-based design studio PINCH and their tour-de-force limited edition Nim table and Swedish artist Hilda Hellström's giant colorful volcano made for the restaurant in London's Ace Hotel. A show called Matter of Stuff near Covent Garden was in on the jesmonite act too, but even more intriguingly was presenting vases made out of Propolis, a resinous material collected by bees and used to seal gaps in hives that, according to their designer Marlene Huissoud, behaves like glass.
- E. Finally, this was the year that Chinese Design finally displayed a well-edited and inspired showcase of products. Despite the mouthful of a title, Icon Presents: Hi Design Shanghai stand at 100% Design was a meaningful selection of designers exploring materials and ideas. Young design duo Yuue's offerings were the most representative of a new conceptual approach to design that seems to be emerging. Their lamps were functional but also thought-provoking and humorous. What more could one want from the stuff that surrounds us?

Part 4

Read the following text for questions 18-28

Sea monsters are the stuff of legend - lurking not just in the depths of the oceans, but also the darker corners of our minds. What is it that draws us to these creatures?

"This inhuman place makes human monsters," wrote Stephen King in his novel *The Shining*. Many academics agree that monsters lurk in the deepest recesses, they prowl through our ancestral minds appearing in the half-light, under the bed - or at the bottom of the sea.

"They don't really exist, but they play a huge role in our mindscapes, in our dreams,

stories, nightmares, myths and so on," says Matthias Classen, assistant professor of literature and media at Aarhus University in Denmark, who studies monsters in literature. "Monsters say something about human psychology, not the world."

One Norse legend talks of the Kraken, a deep sea creature that was the curse of fishermen. If sailors found a place with many fish, most likely it was the monster that was driving them to the surface. If it saw the ship it would pluck the hapless sailors from the boat and drag them to a watery grave.

This terrifying legend occupied the mind and pen of the poet Alfred Lord Tennyson too. In his short 1830 poem *The Kraken* he wrote: "Below the thunders of the upper deep, / Far far beneath in the abysmal sea, / His ancient, dreamless, uninvaded sleep / The Kraken sleepeth."

The deeper we travel into the ocean, the deeper we delve into our own psyche. And when we can go no further - there lurks the Kraken.

Most likely the Kraken is based on a real creature - the giant squid. The huge mollusc takes pride of place as the personification of the terrors of the deep sea. Sailors would have encountered it at the surface, dying, and probably thrashing about. It would have made a weird sight, "about the most alien thing you can imagine," says Edith Widder, CEO at the Ocean Research and Conservation Association.

"It has eight lashing arms and two slashing tentacles growing straight out of its head and it's got serrated suckers that can latch on to the slimiest of prey and it's got a parrot beak that can rip flesh. It's got an eye the size of your head, it's got a jet propulsion system and three hearts that pump blue blood."

The giant squid continued to dominate stories of sea monsters with the famous 1870 novel, *Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea*, by Jules Verne. Verne's submarine fantasy is a classic story of puny man against a gigantic squid.

The monster needed no embellishment - this creature was scary enough, and Verne incorporated as much fact as possible into the story, says Emily Alder from Edinburgh Napier University. "*Twenty Thousand Leagues Under the Sea* and another contemporaneous book, Victor Hugo's *Toilers of the Sea*, both tried to represent the giant squid as they might have been actual zoological animals, much more taking the squid as a biological creature than a mythical creature." It was a given that the squid was vicious and would readily attack humans given the chance.

That myth wasn't busted until 2012, when Edith Widder and her colleagues were the first people to successfully film giant squid under water and see first-hand the true

character of the monster of the deep. They realised previous attempts to film squid had failed because the bright lights and noisy thrusters on submersibles had frightened them away.

By quietening down the engines and using bioluminescence to attract it, they managed to see this most extraordinary animal in its natural habitat. It serenely glided into view, its body rippled with metallic colours of bronze and silver. Its huge, intelligent eye watched the submarine warily as it delicately picked at the bait with its beak. It was balletic and mesmeric. It could not have been further from the gnashing, human-destroying creature of myth and literature. In reality this is a gentle giant that is easily scared and pecks at its food.

Another giant squid lies peacefully in the Natural History Museum in London, in the Spirit Room, where it is preserved in a huge glass case. In 2004 it was caught in a fishing net off the Falkland Islands and died at the surface. The crew immediately froze its body and it was sent to be preserved in the museum by the Curator of Molluscs, Jon Ablett. It is called Archie, an affectionate short version of its Latin name *Architeuthis dux*. It is the longest preserved specimen of a giant squid in the world.

Do the following statements agree with the information given?

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

18.Matthias Classen is unsure about the possibility of monster's existence

- A)** True **B)** False **C)** Not Given

19.Kraken is probably based on an imaginary animal

- A)** True **B)** False **C)** Not Given

20.Previous attempts on filming the squid had failed due to the fact that the creature was scared

- A)** True **B)** False **C)** Not Given

21.Giant squid was caught alive in 2004 and brought to the museum

- A)** True **B)** False **C)** Not Given

22.Jon Ablett admits that he likes Archie

- A)** True **B)** False **C)** Not Given

23.According to Classen, people can be scared both by imaginary and real monsters

- A)** True **B)** False **C)** Not Given

24.Werner Herzog suggests that Kraken is essential to the ocean

- A)** True **B)** False **C)** Not Given

25.Who wrote a novel about a giant squid?

- A** Emily Alder
- B** Stephen King
- C** Alfred Lord Tennyson
- D** Jules Verne

26.What, of the featuring body parts, mollusc DOESN'T have?

- A** two tentacles
- B** serrated suckers
- C** beak
- D** smooth suckers

27.Which of the following applies to the bookish Kraken?

- A** notorious
- B** scary
- C** weird
- D** harmless

28. Where can we see a giant squid?

- A** at the museum
- B** at a seaside
- C** on TV
- D** in supermarkets

Part 5

Read the text below and answer Questions 29-35.

Not long ago, if you were a young, brash technologist with a world-conquering start-up idea, there was a good chance you spent much of your waking life working toward a single business milestone: taking your company public.

Though luminaries of the tech industry have always expressed skepticism and even hostility toward the finance industry, tech's dirty secret was that it looked to Wall Street and the ritual of a public offering for affirmation — not to mention wealth.

The delay in I.P.O.s has altered how some venture capital firms do business. Rather than waiting for an initial offering, Maveron, for instance, says it now sells its stake in a start-up to other, larger private investors once it has made about 100 times its initial investment. It is the sort of return that once was only possible after an I.P.O.

But there is also a downside to the new aversion to initial offerings. When the unicorns do eventually go public and begin to soar — or whatever it is that fantastical horned beasts tend to do when they're healthy — the biggest winners will be the private investors that are now bearing most of the risk.

It used to be that public investors who got in on the ground floor of an initial offering could earn historic gains. If you invested \$1,000 in Amazon at its I.P.O. in 1997, you would now have nearly \$250,000. If you had invested \$1,000 in Microsoft in 1986, you would have close to half a million. Public investors today are unlikely to get anywhere near such gains from tech I.P.O.s. By the time tech companies come to the market, the biggest gains have already been extracted by private backers.

Just 53 technology companies went public in 2014, which is around the median since 1980, but far fewer than during the boom of the late 1990s and 2000, when hundreds of tech companies went public annually, according to statistics maintained by Jay Ritter, a professor of finance at the University of Florida.

Initial public offerings were also ways to compensate employees and founders who owned lots of stock, but there are now novel mechanisms — such as selling shares on a secondary market — for insiders to cash in on some of their shares in private companies. Still, some observers cautioned that the new trend may be a bad deal for employees who aren't given much information about the company's performance.

If the delay in I.P.O.s becomes a normal condition for Silicon Valley, some observers say tech companies may need to consider new forms of compensation for workers. "We probably need to fundamentally rethink how do private companies compensate employees, because that's going to be an issue," said Mr. Kupor, of Andreessen Horowitz.

If the private investors are wrong, employees, founders and a lot of hedge funds could be in for a reckoning. But if they're right, it will be you and me wearing the frown — the public investors who missed out on the next big thing.

Choose the correct letter, A, B, C or D.

29. How much funds would you gain by now, if you had invested 1000\$ in the Amazon in 1997?

- A** 250,000\$
- B** close to 500,000\$
- C** It is not stated in the text
- D** No funds

30. In which time period was the biggest number of companies going public?

- A** early 1990s
- B** late 1900s and 2000s
- C** 1980s
- D** late 1990s

Complete the sentences below.

Write ONLY ONE WORD from the passage for each answer.

Skepticism was always expected by the **31**_____ of tech industry.

The new aversion to initial offerings has its **32**_____.

Selling shares on a secondary market is considered a **33**_____ mechanism.

Workers' compensation might be an **34**_____.

The public investors who failed to participate in the next big thing might be the ones wearing the **35**_____.

SPEAKING TEST

PART 1

Celebrity & Computer

1. Do you use computers?
2. What do you use a computer to do?
3. Did you use computers when you were little?
4. Do people often use computers these days?
5. Will people continue to use computers in the future?
6. Who is your favorite celebrity?
7. Do you like any foreign celebrities?
8. Would you want to be a celebrity in the future?
9. Do you think we should protect famous people's privacy?
10. How do celebrities influence their fans in your country?

PART 2

Describe an important decision you have made.

You should say:

- what the decision was
 - why you made that choice
 - who helped you make the choice
- and explain why the decision was so important.

PART 3

DECISION

1. Why do some people find it hard to make decisions?
2. How important is it to get advice from other people when making decisions?
3. Why is it sometimes difficult to accept advice?
4. What are some of the most important decisions young people have to make?
5. Do you agree that parents should make important decisions for their children?
6. Is it better to make a decision thinking about what you want or thinking about what other people want?

WRITING TEST

Task 1

You recently took a trip with a taxi company. The driver behaved in an unacceptable way and you had a lot of problems. You complained to the company but no-one has replied to your complaint.

Write a letter to the taxi company.

In your letter

- say why you are writing and how you feel
- explain what happened
- tell them what you would like them to do.

Write at least 150 words.

This image shows a single sheet of white paper with horizontal ruling lines. The lines are evenly spaced and run across the width of the page. There are no margins, text, or other markings on the paper.

[illegible]

To what extent do you agree or disagree with this opinion?

[illegible]

[illegible]

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